

Alan Turing (1912–1954)

During World War II, Alan Turing, a brilliant mathematician, helped develop code-breaking machines that eventually led to the invention of modern computers.

The English used Turing's machine to break German codes that were sent through the Enigma machine during World War II.



Tablet

An Apple smartphone



Modern inventions

Imagine the world without these fantastic inventions!



The first **antibiotic**, penicillin, was discovered accidentally.



Modern **cars** are driven by internal combustion engines that run on gas or diesel.



Nuclear power is efficient, but some people think it could harm us.



Plastics technology is used to make many of the things in your home.



Compact discs are small and light, and they store lots of information.

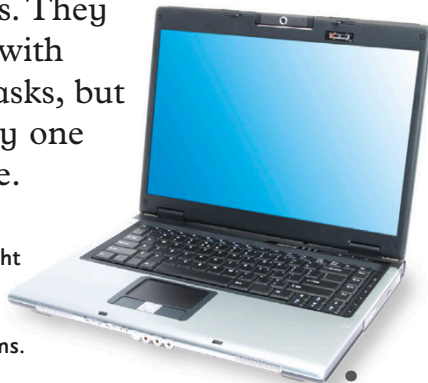


Energy-efficient lightbulbs help save energy in your home.

Computers (1941)

The first computers were huge machines. They couldn't cope with complicated tasks, but worked on only one thing at a time.

Today's laptops can be lightweight and portable. Early computers filled whole rooms.



Cell phones and tablets (1980s)

The first cell phones were large and heavy, weighing about 77 lb (35 kg). Tablet technology has also improved drastically since its invention in the late 1980s.

1900

1950

DNA profiling (1986)

The discovery of DNA (which holds information in human cells) led to DNA profiling, a huge help to the police—criminals can now be identified by a single hair or spot of blood.



Nuclear bombs (1945)

The US dropped two nuclear bombs on Japan in World War II, killing nearly 300,000 people. It is the only time nuclear weapons have been used in war.



The Internet (1990s)

With its roots in the 1960s, the internet (short for internetwork) became public during the mid-1990s, and is now used for fun and education by about 2.5 billion users—70 percent of whom are online every day.

Before DNA profiling, police identified criminals by their fingerprints. This system was developed in the 1890s.